

► Help! My Co-worker is Autistic!?



The Lightning Edition

@DennieDeclercq //29 January 2019

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About me



- ▶ Dennie Declercq
- ▶ Volunteer developer!
- ▶ DDSOFT (nonprofit)
- ▶ [#DreamingIsBelieving](#)
- ▶ [@DennieDeclercq](#)
- ▶ Positive thinker

#7ThYearMagic

A photograph of the Seattle skyline at sunset. The Space Needle is the central focus, standing tall among other skyscrapers. The sky is a mix of orange, pink, and blue. In the foreground, there are some trees and a building with a blue awning.

- ▶ 7 Years of
 - ▶ Volunteering
 - ▶ People with disabilities
- ▶ 7 is Magic
 - ▶ Life dream!

Autism



- ▶ A mismatch between:
 - ▶ Social Relationship
 - ▶ Communication
 - ▶ Imagination
- ▶ A Disability
- ▶ Being unique
- ▶ A very personal experience

Developers Logic vs Autistic Logic

Developers Logic

- A boolean is true or false
- It's good to declare variables, what type it's expect
- If you program a loop, the exit scenario should be clear
- It's very structured

Autistic Logic

- A fact is only true or false
- It's very nice that every circumstance is declared
- If there's a path to follow, auti's like it's clear and clean
- Most of them are very structured

Behaviour



Too Honest

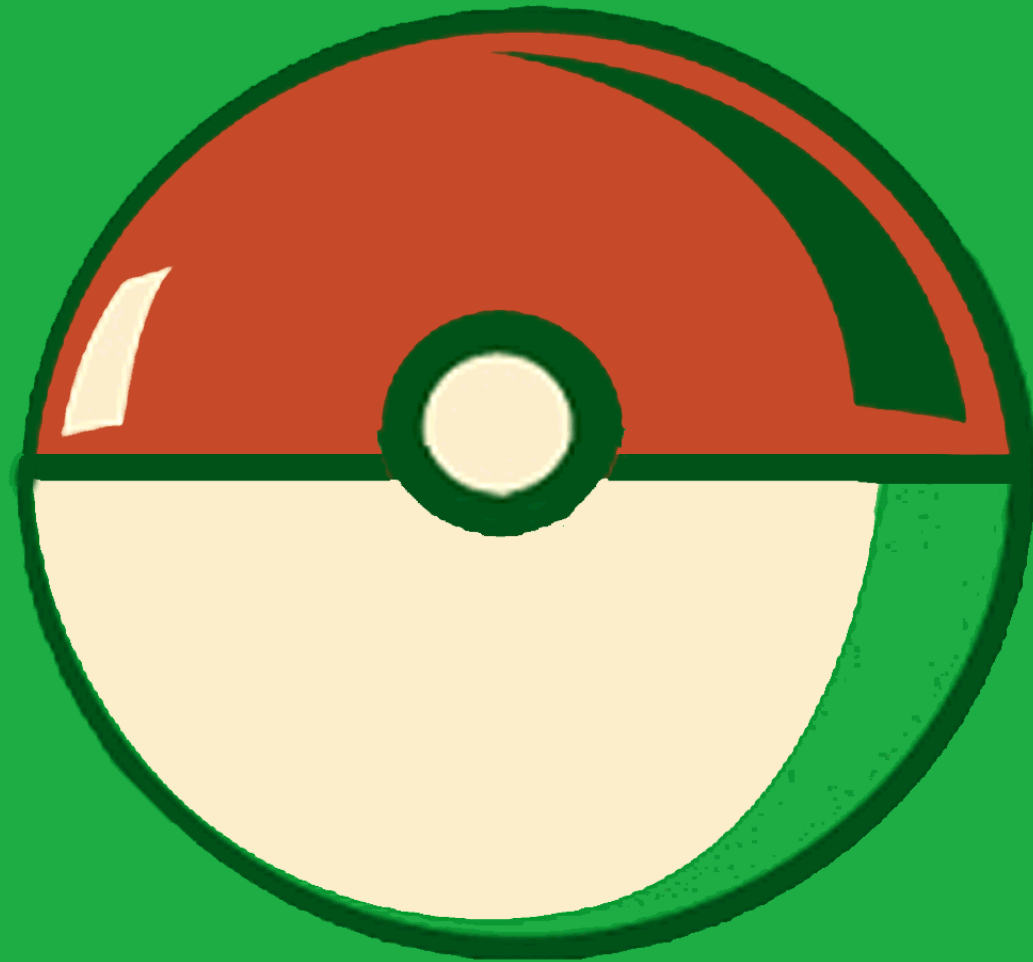
What is wrong with your face?

Cope with deadlines

A black cat with white paws is sitting on a silver laptop keyboard. The laptop is open and sits on a wooden table. The background is a blurred indoor setting with a shelf and some items.

DEADLINE IS COMING

Limited topics of interest



Talking: Too much or too little

STOP TALKING

Jokes?

It's a joke.



Solution: The autism-friendly co-worker
(== How to handle people with autism)



Structure

Difficulty

- ▶ Unorganized
- ▶ From A to D without B and C
- ▶ Weird way of structuring a 'programming environment'

Solution

- ▶ Help organizing
- ▶ Ask clarity
- ▶ Help setting up an environment
- ▶ Explain what is important and why

Planning

Difficulty

- ▶ Planning is too hard
- ▶ Impulsive planning
- ▶ Cancelled meetings

Solution

- ▶ Help with planning
- ▶ Set your own limits to meetings
- ▶ Send an easy reminder

Communication

Difficulty

- ▶ Talking too much
- ▶ Jokes
- ▶ Limited topics of interest

Solution

- ▶ Plan specific timeslots
- ▶ Explain your jokes
- ▶ Ask a few times about their interest
- ▶ Keep telling about your own interests!
- ▶ Set and show your own limits and indicate them

Work and deadlines

Difficulty

- ▶ Can't cope with deadlines
- ▶ Works slower
- ▶ Specific detail view

Solution

- ▶ Give project without deadlines
- ▶ Don't prioritize the deadline
- ▶ Make small goals
- ▶ Create time

Q&A | | Thank you!



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